

iQOO Neo 10R

The gaming phone you were waiting for!

India is experiencing a surge in mobile gaming. What was once frowned upon by our Indian parents, has now become a career path for many young Indians. According to a report by SME Street, the online gaming industry in India is expected to reach \$5 billion by 2025, growing at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of over 30%. This also explains why we need more performance phones now than ever. Speaking of which, the iQOO Neo 10R has been launched in India for Rs 26,999, promising a robust performance in the segment. As you may already know, many young Indians aspire to buy a flagship phone for gaming but end up getting a mid-range or a budget one due to financial constraints.

So, can the iQOO Neo 10R deliver the performance a gamer needs for extensive gaming sessions? Moreover, apart from performance, how well does the smartphone perform in other parameters? Well, I believe those details are exactly what you are here for – so let's begin!

PERFORMANCE

There are two colours of this smartphone – Raging Blue and MoonKnight Titanium. I have the Raging Blue variant and to be honest, this one looks so much better. It has a dual-toned design, merging with a pattern reminiscent of the finish line on racing tracks. It has a squarish camera module, something similar to what we have seen on the iQOO 12, but with a dual camera setup.

Fortunately, you also get an IR blaster on the iQOO Neo 10R and you can use your phone as a remote for your

₹26,999



TV, AC, and other home appliances. Moreover, the grip and feel of this smartphone are also nice, which is very important for gaming. But wait...we mostly hold our phones horizontally while gaming. And when I do that, the camera bump often gets in the way as your finger uncomfortably rests on the camera module. But with the Neo 10R, the grip was completely fine.

What could have been slightly better here is the durability. To safeguard against dust and water, this phone features an IP65 rating, which is still decent. You are, however, more likely to damage your phone due to a hard drop rather than dust or water. And to shield you against such drops, you are only getting Schott Xensation protection which falls short of options like Gorilla Glass Victus that are also available in the budget.

DISPLAY

The iQOO Neo 10R comes with a 6.78-inch 1.5K AMOLED panel, which supports up to 144Hz refresh rate. But the catch here is that only three games support a 144Hz high refresh rate on this smartphone. Otherwise, the display runs at a 120Hz refresh rate at all times.

If I talk about how bright this display is, we recorded 2000 nits of peak brightness in manual mode, and under direct sunlight, it seems bright enough.

In our display test using professional grade Calman and Spectral Colourimeter, the Neo 10R got an average delta E of 0.9 in the professional colour profile, which is exceptional, and the screen can reproduce close to 100% of the sRGB colour space. This means that you can expect greater colour accuracy while watching videos, movies and TV shows on YouTube or OTT apps. Furthermore, the display supports over 1000Hz touch sampling rate in the gaming mode, which makes the gaming experience ever so smooth.

PERFORMANCE

The iQOO Neo 10R is powered by the Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 processor, which is paired with 8GB and 12GB RAM. The iQOO Neo 10R performed really well in all our tests.

Starting with AnTuTu, this smartphone scored 15,27,083 points, which is a really good score for a sub-Rs 30,000 smartphone. The only other smartphone under Rs 30,000 that came close was the Poco X7 Pro, with 15,38,176 points.

Similarly, with Geekbench, the close fight was between the iQOO Neo 10R and Poco X7 Pro, and the scores are pretty interesting.

Apart from scoring well in benchmarks, the iQOO Neo 10R also stood up tall when it came to stress tests. During a 15-minute CPU Throttling test, the iQOO Neo 10R throttled very little, which means the smartphone is stable and the thermal management is also good.